

College Lost & Found System

PROJECT STATEMENT & SCOPE SPECIFICATION

Problem Definition

Project Scope

System Architecture

Problem Statement

In busy academic environments such as colleges and universities, students and faculty frequently lose personal belongings—ranging from student ID cards, notebooks, and electronics to keys and wallets. Traditional methods of handling misplaced items, such as physical notice boards or fragmented department desks, are inefficient, disorganized, and decentralized.

Items found by peers often never reach their rightful owners because there is no quick, centralized, or searchable repository to match lost items with found reports. This results in unnecessary stress, administrative overhead, and unrecovered property.

Scope of the Project

The **College Lost & Found System** is designed as a lightweight, console-based modular software solution written in Python. Its core scope includes:

- **Record Management:** Providing structured data entry for both lost and found belongings with item attributes (name, location, date, contact details).
- **Search & Retrieval:** Enabling users to look up specific items by name to identify potential matches.
- **Inventory Overview:** Displaying organized lists of all currently registered lost and found items.
- **Session Lifecycle:** Maintaining data integrity throughout an active terminal session using a structured command-line menu loop.

Target Users

Students

Individuals who misplace study materials, IDs, or devices and need a straightforward way to check if someone has found them.

Campus Faculty & Staff

Instructors and campus personnel who discover abandoned items and require a reliable method to log and return them.

Campus Administration

Operators managing general campus lost-and-found inquiries looking for clean, organized item tracking.

System Maintainers

Developers maintaining a clean, modular Python codebase using separation of concerns across files.

High-Level Features

- **Interactive CLI Navigation:** Intuitive numeric menu loop for straightforward user control.
- **Lost Item Logging:** Record items lost with precise location and contact details.
- **Found Item Logging:** Register found belongings to facilitate easy claims.